

What to do when facing a Content ID claim

YouTube has a Content ID system which has all the copyrighted work by original creators. Whenever you upload a video, its content is matched with that in the database and if there is a match, a copyright notice is sent to you. After this, your video can be taken down, the audio can be muted or in some cases even your channel be shut down.

But it is not necessary that you are in the wrong.

First review the content ID claim and decide what you want to do. You have a couple of options to choose from. You can either,

- Accept the claim and do nothing about it if you think it is justified.
- Re-upload the video after removing the dispute content from it
- If you were earning some revenue from the disputed content you can offer to share it with the original copyright owner.
- If you think your use lies under fair use, you can dispute the claim.

If you decide to dispute the Content ID claim, you can need to be sure that your created content lies under the purview of fair use. You can file the dispute using the YouTube video manager. Once you submit your dispute, the owner of the claim has 30 days to respond to it and till then the claim will be temporarily withdrawn. After you dispute the claimant can do one of the following 4 things

- Release the claim and everything will be back to normal.
- Uphold the claim. If the claim is upheld you can still choose to appeal the decision
- Takedown your video. The owner can submit a Copyright takedown request' and your video will be removed from YouTube while your account will get a copyright strike. Though you need to be more careful after a copyright strike, since your account can be terminated and all your video might be removed if you get too many strikes in a short period of time. Currently, the limit is three strikes. You can also work towards getting strikes removed by undertaking workshops on Copyright but those are on a case to case basis. 